Pacific Tsunami Warning Center - Annual Report 2026

Executive summary. In 2026 the Pacific Tsunami Warning Center recorded 14 tsunami events across the Pacific basin. The largest was event PT-2026-0412 on 12 March 2026, with a peak wave height of 3.2 metres measured near Sumatra.

The average warning lead time for coastal communities was 11 minutes, an improvement of two minutes over the previous year.

Sensor network. At the end of 2026 the network operated 62 DART buoys. Eight buoys were recalibrated in March after drift was detected in their bottom pressure recorders.

Seismic stations reported 1,240 earthquakes above magnitude 5.0, of which 31 triggered a tsunami watch.

Community outreach. The center ran evacuation drills in 48 coastal towns and trained 3,600 local volunteers. Siren coverage reached 87 percent of the high-risk shoreline.

Budget. Operating expenditure for 2026 was 18.4 million dollars, of which 6.1 million funded buoy maintenance.

Recommendations. The center recommends adding 10 new DART buoys in the Banda Sea and reducing the warning lead time target to 9 minutes by 2028.